

9.7 The Disk Cleanup Utility

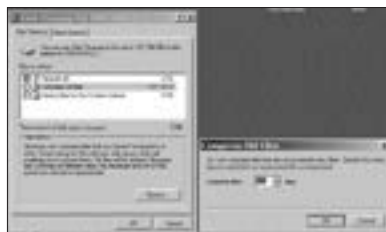
When you right-click on a drive in Windows Explorer and select Properties, the first tab that greets you has a pie-chart that shows how much of the disk is full. Just next to the pie-chart is a button that says “Disk Cleanup.” This is a handy little tool that helps you reclaim space on the drive you selected.

Clicking ‘Disk Cleanup’ presents you with two tabs, with a total of six options. Here’s a brief description.



The Disk Cleanup button is in the General tab

1. Checking the box next to ‘Recycle Bin’ and pressing ‘OK’ will, of course, empty the Recycle Bin. Clicking ‘View Files’ simply displays the contents of the Recycle Bin.
2. Choosing to ‘Compress old files’ will compress files that haven’t been accessed in a while. You will, naturally, gain disk space as a result. Note that compressed files aren’t encrypted or disabled in any way—you can still access them.



Compress old files to save disk space

Clicking ‘Options’ with ‘Compress old files’ selected leads you to a dialog box that asks you when to compress old files, or, in